Matthew Abiodun Diyaolu

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Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Arkansas — Expected 2028
Advisor: Arya Gaduh. Doctoral candidate since December 2025.

M.A., Economics, University of Arkansas — 2024

M.B.A., Finance, University of Lagos — 2019

B.Sc. (Hons.), Economics, University of Ibadan — 2014
Second Class Upper Division

Research Fields

Applied Microeconomics, Development Economics, Labor Economics, Experimental Economics

Dissertation Research

Off the Books: How Child Marriage Law Pushes Young Couples into Religious Unions

Studies whether Indonesia's 2019 reform raising the minimum legal marriage age for women from 16 to 19 reduced early marriage or pushed young couples into unregistered religious unions, using national household survey microdata.

A Year for the Nation or a Year Lost? National Service and Labor Market Outcomes in Nigeria

Uses the age cut-off at graduation that determines participation in Nigeria's compulsory national service to estimate its effect on the school-to-work transition.

Equal Outcome, Unequal Investment: Observability and Household Spending on Fostered Children in Nigeria

Studies how the observability of household spending shapes investment in fostered relative to biological children.

Other Work in Progress

Do Moral Frames Reduce Congestion and Environmental Externalities? Evidence from an Incentivized Laboratory Experiment on Tourism Choices

Do Child Protection Laws Change Fertility and Maternal Investment Decisions? Evidence from Nigeria's Child Rights Act

Teaching Experience

Instructor of record, University of Arkansas

Principles of Microeconomics (undergraduate) — Spring 2026 – present
Basic Economics (undergraduate) — Fall 2024 – Fall 2025

Graduate Teaching and Research Assistant, University of Arkansas — 2023 – 2024

Academic Tutor, University of Ibadan 2011 – 2014

Professional Experience

Senior Manager, Reinsurance and Data Analysis 2020 – 2023
Ark Insurance Brokers Ltd., Lagos

- Analysed insurers' financial statements to rate underwriting counterparties; allocating business by financial strength improved claim recoveries by at least 15%.

Executive, Life and General Business Reinsurance 2017 – 2020
Cornerstone Insurance Plc, Lagos

- Technical analysis of facultative inward and outward risks, claims recoveries, and process automation.

Graduate Trainee, Actuarial Services and Internal Audit 2016 – 2017
Cornerstone Insurance Plc, Lagos

Professional Qualifications

Chartered Property Casualty Underwriter (CPCU), The Institutes 2025
Associate in Risk Management (ARM), The Institutes 2023
Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate 2022
Associate Chartered Accountant (ACA), ICAN, Nigeria 2021
Associate, Chartered Insurance Institute of Nigeria 2021
Investment Foundations Certificate, CFA Institute 2019

Honours and Awards

Young Insurance Professionals Programme, Distinction, Africa Re 2020
Best Student in Econometrics, University of Ibadan 2013
Dean's Roll of Honour, University of Ibadan 2011 – 2013

Skills

R, Stata, Python (reproducible empirical analysis of survey and administrative microdata)

References

Available upon request.

Last updated: November 2026